

Upgrading Your PC

Remember the time when a 386 machine was considered more than enough for everybody, for everything—from games to programming? Remember the ads in newspapers with prices falling by the day? It was around that time that the hunger for increased processing power began, and it was around the same time that the upgrade races too gained momentum.

As time passed, and as people's needs increased—sometimes reasonably, sometimes driven by marketing and advertising—we saw more and more powerful home computers enter the market.

But it's not possible to buy a new computer every year and so we upgrade parts of our existing computer that we think are the most important like the memory and the hard drive.

Upgrading computers used to be the forte of the elite few called hardware engineers. But with increased availability of information and awareness, reduced complexities in installing devices, upgrading and maintaining a computer is now simpler.

First and foremost, you need to have the curiosity to peer inside the dusty tower you call your computer. Having some knowledge of computers is helpful, but curiosity is the driving force. One thing you need to understand is that upgrading a computer is not going to be a walk in the park, and there are pitfalls and stumbling blocks. However, it need not be a tedious job either, and you can also have fun fiddling with your machine.

This book covers several upgrading issues ranging from the operating system to the hardware. Sections such as 'Opening Pandora's Box', and 'Companions For Your PC' will help you understand the installation of devices while having fun wiring them up. We are also talking about modems and networks territory.

Troubleshooting software issues and finding help for these is also covered as is a special Q&A section, answering queries related to upgrading, is also a part of this book. We finish off with a thorough bibliography of essential books and resources that will satisfy your thirst to know more. While you may be tempted to skip certain sections of the book, BIOS settings and other such sections are important and we recommend you not to skip these. Let's upgrade!